

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 10 7 6

♥ 8 3 2

♦ K 6 5

♣ J 8 4

♠ A

♥ A K J 10 7 4

♦ A 9 3

♣ 6 5 3



♠ Q 3 2

♥ 9 5

♦ Q 8 7 2

♣ K Q 10 9

♠ J 9 8 5 4

♥ Q 6

♦ J 10 4

♣ A 7 2

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

3 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

You respond 1 ♠, your 5-card Major. Partner jumps to 3 ♥.

Make your next bid.

Partner is showing 16-18 points and you have 9. Since he rebid ♥s he must have at least six of them you you know there is an 8-card fit. You bid 4 ♥.

South would play 4 ♥.

Click

North plays 4 ♥. East leads the ♣K.

North plays 4 ♥. East leads the ♣K.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 2 : Total = 4

You might consider setting up dummy's ♠ suit for a discard but there are too few entries to make that work.

More promising is playing West to have at least one of the ♦ honors and taking two finesses in that suit. **BUT**, entries are still a problem. You can only reach dummy twice, once with the ♣A and once with the ♥Q, and you must play ♦s each time you are there.

Win the first trick with the ♣A and play the ♦J, letting it ride if West doesn't cover. East will win this trick and take two ♣s. He will probably then lead a ♠. You win your ♠A, play ♥A then a small ♥ to dummy's ♥Q. Now lead a ♦ and finesse with your ♦9. When this wins, pull trumps and claim.

Taking two finesses in ♦s will be successful whenever West holds the ♦K **OR** the ♦Q **OR** both the ♦K Q.

This will happen about 75% of the time, so the double finesse is a good Plan. And on this Deal it was the only plan available.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A J 6 5 2

♥ 10 4

♦ Q 7 4 3

♣ J 6

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ 9 7 3

♦ K J 6 2

♣ 8 2



♠ 7

♥ A K Q 8 6 2

♦ A 5

♣ Q 9 5 3

♠ 9 8 4

♥ J 5

♦ 10 9 8

♣ A K 10 7 4

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

3 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by East

plays ♣8 then ♣2.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 3 : Total = 4

Suppose you discard a ♦ from dummy. If North doesn't ruff this ♣10 then your ♣Q will win. You could then try to establish dummy's ♦Q to discard your fourth ♣ on.

But you know that plan won't work because North **IS** going to ruff this ♣ if you discard. You only have one chance to make this contract, and that is the chance that North was not dealt the ♥J. So you ruff with dummy's ♥10 and pray North doesn't over-ruff.

The prayer was answered, North did not hold the ♥J.

So you won that trick and still had your ♣Q to use after you pulled trumps.

You respond with your 5-card Major, 1 ♠.

Partner jumps to 3 ♥.

With partner's 16-18 points you probably have enough strength for game.

With partner's six ♥s you have an 8-card fit.

So you bid 4 ♥.

West would play 4 ♥.

Click

East plays 4 ♥. South leads ♣A, ♣K, ♣4. North plays ♣8 then ♣2.

East plays 4 ♥. South leads ♣A, ♣K, ♣4. North